DCTVU

DC TELEVISION UNIVERSE

Franchise Bible — Volume 03: The Slate & Series 3 Launch Network

FORMAT • TONE • CONTINUITY • CANON • TEAMS & FOUNDING ROSTERS

An alternate-history story told through Hollywood trades, headlines,
social media, the internet, and screenplay-format scenes.

Story present: 2010.
Six live-action series + two animated series. One multiverse.

Internal development document. Fictional actors and the individual series to be created in later volumes.

Section 1 — Locked: The DCTVU Series Slate

STATUS: LOCKED. Series titles, concepts, and characters stay reserved for you. Placeholders are used until you name them.

Series	Run	Seasons	Network	DCTVU status / setting
Live-Action 1	2012–2020	8	The CW	The original DCTVU series: the main DCTVU Earth.
Live-Action 2	2014–2023	9	The CW	Spinoff of LA1, same DCTVU Earth.
Live-Action 3	2015–2021	6	**CBS** (S1) → The CW (S2–S6)	Set on a **separate Earth**. Retroactively incorporated into the DCTVU from S2, and **definitively linked** to the rest of the franchise in S5.
Live-Action 4	2016–2022	7	The CW	Spinoff set in the DCTVU, built from characters introduced in LA1 and LA2 plus new characters.
Live-Action 5	2018–2021	4	The CW	Starts on its **own separate Earth** and is outside the DCTVU in S1–S2. It joins in **S3** with its first tie-ins.
Live-Action 6	2019–2022	3	The CW	Part of the DCTVU from day one.
Animated 1	2015–2016	2	Cartoon Network	Set in the DCTVU.
Animated 2	2017–2018	2	Cartoon Network	Part of the DCTVU, but primarily set on a **different Earth** that is a **parallel Earth** to the one shared by LA1, LA2, LA4, and Animated 1.

Earth map (designations to be assigned by you)

Earth	Series
Main DCTVU Earth	LA1, LA2, LA4, LA6, Animated 1 (and LA3 and LA5 once linked)
Separate Earth A	LA3 (alone in S1; DCTVU-adjacent from S2; definitively linked in S5)
Separate Earth B	LA5 (alone in S1–S2; tie-ins begin in S3)
Parallel Earth C	Animated 2 (parallel to the main DCTVU Earth)

Section 2 — Season-by-Season Calendar

This calendar uses the classic September–May network season. Two series need **midseason (January) premieres** for the dates and season counts to line up. That's realistic, and it's how The CW launched new dramas in that era.

TV season	LA1	LA2	LA3	LA4	LA5	LA6	Animated	On air (LA)
2012–13	S1 (Oct 2012)							1
2013–14	S2							1
2014–15	S3	S1 (Oct 2014)						2
2015–16	S4	S2	S1 (CBS)	S1 (Jan 2016)			A1 S1 (2015)	4
2016–17	S5	S3	S2 (CW)	S2			A1 S2 (2016)	4
2017–18	S6	S4	S3	S3	S1 (Jan 2018)		A2 S1 (2017)	5
2018–19	S7	S5	S4	S4	S2		A2 S2 (2018)	5
2019–20	S8 (final, 2020)	S6	S5 (linked)	S5	S3 (joins)	S1 (Oct 2019)		**6**
2020–21		S7	S6 (final, 2021)	S6	S4 (final, 2021)	S2		5
2021–22		S8		S7 (final, 2022)		S3 (final, 2022)		3
2022–23		S9 (final, 2023)						1

Peak year: the 2019–20 season is the only one with all six live-action series on air at once. It is also when LA3 is definitively linked, LA5 joins, LA6 premieres, and LA1 ends. It's the natural year for the franchise's biggest crossover event.

Real-world calendar notes: LA2 S9 (2022–23) is the franchise's final season. Broadcast seasons in 2020–21 should reflect real-world pandemic production delays in a realistic telling.

Section 3 — Where Live-Action 3 Premieres

> **RECOMMENDATION: CBS.** Live-Action 3 premieres on **CBS in fall 2015**, then moves to **The CW** for Season 2 in fall 2016.

- **CBS co-owns The CW.** CBS Corporation and Warner Bros. each own half of The CW, so the move from Season 1 to Season 2 is a corporate-family transfer, not a sale to a rival. It is the only big-four network where such a move is easy.
- **Its own Earth fits a different network.** LA3 starts on a separate Earth with no on-screen ties to the DCTVU. A different network reinforces that separation, and the move to The CW becomes the business-side version of the story's retroactive incorporation into the DCTVU in Season 2.
- **A bigger launch platform.** CBS is the most-watched network in America in 2015, so LA3 gets a big-four marketing push and a large premiere audience. That raises the profile of the whole DC brand.
- **Production continuity.** Warner Bros. Television produces for CBS as well as The CW, so the cast, crew, and creative team can carry over. For Season 2, production can move to Vancouver, alongside the other DCTVU series, to cut costs.
- **A realistic reason for the move.** CBS's audience skews older and its license fees are expensive. If LA3's Season 1 ratings are solid but the cost per episode is high, CBS can hand it to its sister network The CW, where it becomes a top performer. That's exactly the kind of story the 2016 trades would cover.

Recommended CBS slot

Mondays at 8:00 PM ET/PT, premiering in late October 2015, with a full 20-episode first season. CBS's Monday comedies provide a strong lead-out, and the late-October launch avoids the September premiere crush.

Alternatives considered

Network	Why it loses to CBS
NBC / ABC / FOX	No ownership link to The CW, so a move would mean a cancellation followed by a new deal between rivals. That's slow, uncertain, and rare.
TNT / TBS	Time Warner-owned, but cable networks order 10–13 episodes and draw smaller audiences. The move would downgrade the show's launch.
Netflix / streaming	Too early. Original streaming drama is only beginning in 2015, and it doesn't fit our classic broadcast model.